

GP-49-HI(FTR) 4 Jan - 11 Nov 1942
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GR 49-Hi (FTR)
4 JAN. - 11 Nov., 1942

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P.R.C.

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HEADQUARTERS
FORTY NINTH FIGHTER GROUP
A.P.O. 929

11 November 1942

SUBJECT: History of Headquarters and Headquarters Squadron, 49th Fighter Group, in Australia.

TO : Commanding General, Headquarters, Fifth Air Force, A.P.O. 923.

1. In compliance with letter dated November 2, 1942, subject, "History of Air Force Organizations in Australia", the following information is submitted:

a. Headquarters and Headquarters Squadron, 49th Fighter Group (then 49th Pursuit Group) left Morrison Field, West Palm Beach, Florida, on January 4th, for port of embarkation, San Francisco, California, and departed from same on January 12, 1942.

b. Group arrived in Australia at Melbourne, Victoria, on February 2, 1942.

c. Camp Darley, Victoria, February 2, to February 15th.
Bankstown Aerodrome, N.S.W., Feb. 16, to April 5th.
Ascot Field, Queensland, during transit.
34-Mile, Darwin, N.T., April 10, to September 26th.
Durand Field, Port Morseby, N.G., October 8th, to present.

d. Col. Paul B. Wurtsmith to 8/7/42; Lt. Col. Donald R. Hutchinson from 8/7/42 to present.

e. Upon arrival in Australia, Headquarters and Headquarters Squadron had 21 Officers and 223 enlisted men and of this personnel approximately 30% were thoroughly trained.

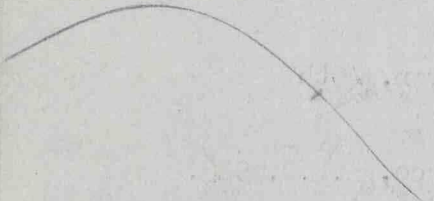
f. To date organization has been in combat over seven months. Effective September 1st, Headquarters and Headquarters Squadron, 49th Fighter Group, was reorganized, as per T.O. 1-12, Special Order #81, and the personnel was reduced to 20 Officers and 49 enlisted men.

Herman A. Tapper
HERMAN A. TAPPER
1st Lt., Air Corps
Adjutant

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